

When I completed my Gallup Clifton Strengths assessment, my dominant set of strengths or theme was Strategic Thinking. Strategic Thinking helps you absorb and analyse information that informs better decisions. According to Gallup, the theme ‘describes more than just having a plan. People especially talented in this theme consider the world through a series of contingencies, contemplating quickly and constantly about the “what if” scenarios of a day, an event, an interaction, or a lifetime’.

If you think this Strategic Thinking theme description sounds like it could fit within The Discerner Money Type’s list of strengths, you’re right. If you remember, the ability to think strategically is one of my financial strengths within my Discerner Money Type. My point is that your strengths and weaknesses shouldn’t be a surprise to you and may have already been uncovered by other tests that should complement what you discover about your Money Type.

My secondary Money Type is the Worker. When I am stressed or feeling unsafe, I find myself leaning towards my Worker tendencies, and will work from dusk to dawn seven days a week. It makes me feel better, safe, in control and like I’m accomplishing something. When I’m given space and time, I love nothing more than relying on my Discerner Money Type of thinking, being strategic and planning; however, again, in times of stress I can find myself overthinking and needing to create more and more detailed scenarios that I have no hope of carrying out. It’s a case of paralysis by analysis so I simply put my head down, lean into my Worker Money Type and work. Interestingly, I’m in flow and at my best financially when I’ve engaged my strategic, discerning, thought leadership strengths (Discerner) and I’m using my ability to build, work hard and see something through over the long term (Worker). I’m utilising the best of both my primary and secondary Money Types.

If you can see yourself in a couple of different Money Types, chances are it’s because you’re a combination as well.

As you answer the questions in the next chapter’s worksheet recap, make sure you think about and answer for your primary and secondary Money Types. Include how the combination works for you and how it works against you. That way, you can identify when you’re being pulled into negative habits by your Money Types and, just as importantly, how you can actively use them to positively affect your finances.

You might be like me and recognise that you allow your weaker Money Type to take over in times of stress, in ways that don’t always serve you. Or maybe